CHRIS LAZAR

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LinkedIn | GitHub | ICLR 2025 Workshop Paper

SUMMARY

AI/LLM Engineer with 2.5 years building and shipping production end to end LLM systems at Dell — spanning RAG + Agentic pipelines, document intelligence, multimodal models. Co-author of an ICLR 2025 workshop paper on text-to-SQL.

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

LLM & AI: RAG, LLM fine-tuning, quantization, prompt engineering,ICL + Reasoning, LLM alignment, multimodal LLMs, text-to-SQL, on-device inference, LangFuse (observability)
Frameworks: PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, FastAI, LangChain, LangGraph, vLLM, ONNX Runtime, LlamaCPP
Languages: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL
MLOps / Infra: FastAPI, Docker, Kubernetes, Harbor, GitHub Actions, AWS(S3/EC2), CI/CD
Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, vector databases (pgvector)
Observability: Langfuse, structured logging
ML: NLP, Computer Vision, OCR, Doc Intelligence

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DELL | ***AI/LLM Engineer (Data Scientist)*** | Austin, TX SEP 2023 – PRESENT

- **Multilingual Contract Intelligence:** Sole engineer on a production LLM system that cut analyst contract review from hours to minutes — processing 50-page contracts in 2–5 min (200-page docs in ~10 min) across 8 languages (EN, FR, ES, FI, ZH, JA, KO, PT). Built a translate → identify non-standard clauses → back-translate pipeline using an ensemble clause-detection approach, deployed via Python FastAPI backend, React frontend, Docker (Harbor), and Kubernetes with LangFuse observability.
- **Contract Field Extraction:** Independently designed and deployed a two-service FastAPI system that automates extraction of 10+ structured contract fields (customer name, theatre, geographic scope, effective/expiration dates, amendment dates, TOC) — eliminating manual data entry for analysts who now only proofread. Services triggered by cron jobs polling SharePoint for new uploads; results pushed to QuickBase via API. Secrets managed with Vault.
- **LLM Inference Optimization:** Reduced inference time to sub-2 seconds and first-token latency to 500ms for Dell's Digital Human Chatbot by applying advanced quantization, attention mechanism refinement, and SOTA inference engines.
- **Company-Wide LLM Evaluation Framework:** Authored the internal benchmarking standard for LLM performance at Dell, defining and implementing metrics for time-to-first-token, throughput, and memory utilization across model deployments.
- **RAG Patent — 20% Cost Reduction:** Led R&D resulting in a filed patent pending approval on a Retrieval-Augmented Generation framework that reduced inference costs by 20% and improved AI-driven customer service efficiency. Research spanned compression techniques and LLM alignment.
- **On-Device LLM Deployment (Investor Relations):** Achieved 50-second end-to-end processing for a 7B-parameter LLM on a laptop GPU by optimizing inference engines for low-resource environments — enabling fully on-device AI for a sensitive investor relations use case.
- **Accounts Receivable Copilot:** Built a text-to-SQL solution using fine-tuned models, few-shot learning, and prompt engineering, achieving 80% accuracy. Extended with ensemble candidate generation and self correction to improve robustness for financial operations workflows.

EXTENDEED | ***Data Scientist*** | Remote JAN 2023 – APR 2023

- Engineered 10 new features from S&P 500 financial data and implemented LSTM, Decision Tree, and CNN models, achieving 18% returns with a 5% maximum drawdown. Integrated models into the live trading platform via Python and Flask.

DELL | ***Data Scientist Intern*** | Austin, TX JUN 2022 – AUG 2022

- Increased purchase order information extraction accuracy from 40% to 86% by identifying the optimal OCR-free NLP model and building an end-to-end pipeline with Swin Transformer and BART — automating multilingual extraction (EN + FR) and increasing processed orders by 35%.
- Curated and annotated English and French PO datasets, contributing to projected savings of $1M+.

PUBLICATIONS

Co-authored workshop paper accepted at **ICLR 2025** — *"How Does Entropy Influence Modern Text-to-SQL Systems?"*
(Kausika*, Lazar*, Mishra, Jha, Pathak)
*Equal Contribution

EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science — Arizona State University AUG 2021 – MAY 2023
Coursework: Deep Learning, AI, NLP, Data Intensive Systems for ML, Bio-Inspired AI & Optimization

B.Tech. Computer Science — Vellore Institute of Technology MAY 2017 – JUL 2021
Coursework: Calculus, Statistics, Discrete Math, Digital Logic, Computer Architecture, OS, DSA